

Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 8

The best book-style foldable money can buy

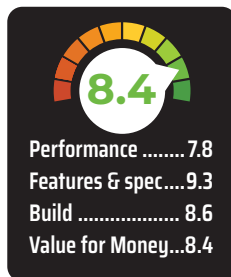
There are phones that impress you when you first pick them up, and then there are phones that change the way you think about smartphones. The latter used to happen more often when phone designs were actually exciting. But in 2026, I can safely say the Galaxy Z Fold 8 is firmly in the second category for me. I have been using this phone as my daily driver for over a month now, and after living with this device every day, I have started to question why slab phones have become so tall in the first place. Even something like the iPhone 17 now looks unusually tall to me. The Fold 8, on the other hand, feels comfortable, compact, and incredibly easy to use.

Of course, there are still a few things I would change, especially the lack of a telephoto camera, and some apps still show letterboxing. But beyond those issues, the Galaxy Z Fold 8 has become the most enjoyable phone I have used this year. Here's my full review.

THE FORM FACTOR IS GREAT

Let me start with the obvious. I still absolutely love the design of the Galaxy Z Fold 8. I have already spoken at length about this in my first impressions and early review, but after using the phone for longer, I can say that my initial excitement has not gone away. If anything, it has become stronger.

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The Fold 8 has the kind of form factor that makes you realise just how accustomed we have become to tall, narrow slab phones.

When I first picked up the Galaxy Z Fold 8, I described it as feeling like the foldable Samsung should have made in the first place. After using it as my main phone, I stand by that statement.

The 5.5-inch Dynamic AMOLED 2X cover display is not simply a smaller version of a normal smartphone screen. It has definitely changed how I interact with the Fold 8. For instance, I can comfortably hold it in one hand, scroll through X, reply to messages, check notifications, browse websites, and do plenty of other things without feeling like I am stretching my fingers across a giant slab. And this is something I did not fully appreciate until I went back to other phones. As I already mentioned

above, even the iPhone 17 now looks incredibly tall to me, which I know may sound strange to some because the iPhone 17 is by no means a big phone.

Then, of course, you can unfold it. And this is where the Galaxy Z Fold 8 becomes something you have never seen before. The 7.6-inch Dynamic AMOLED 2X inner display with a 120Hz refresh rate and 4:3 aspect ratio feels much more natural for reading,

browsing, gaming, and consuming content. It does not feel like Samsung simply took a regular smartphone and stretched it into a tablet.

The entire interface feels intentional and designed around the extra space. I have found myself reading more on the Fold 8 than I expected.

Articles, documents, and ebooks are all far more comfortable on this display, and the 4:3 ratio gives you a much more natural canvas.

Samsung has also done a great job with the crease. It is still there, obviously, but it is far less noticeable than on previous generations. The combination of the new hinge mechanism, Flex Titanium, and the anti-reflective coating makes the inner display feel much more refined.

There is one downside, though. The smooth matte finish is quite slippery. I have had moments where I have been genuinely worried about the phone sliding out of my pocket. It is one of those situations where the phone looks and feels premium, but you would probably want a case for peace of mind. I haven't got one yet, but I am looking forward to getting a good case or maybe a carbon-fiber skin.

The hinge is another part of the design that I really like. The spring-loaded mechanism gives the Fold 8 a satisfying snap when you open it completely. It is a small thing, but it makes using the phone feel more mechanical and deliberate.